

Affordable pet healthcare guide — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

FIND LOW-COST CLINIC TYPES

- ☐ **Search for nonprofit veterinary clinics in your area using terms like "affordable pet clinic," "community pet clinic," or "Humane Society" to find clinics with 30-60% below standard pricing.:** Search for nonprofit veterinary clinics in your area using terms like "affordable pet clinic," "community pet clinic," or "Humane Society" to find clinics with 30-60% below standard pricing.
- ☐ **Look for shelter-affiliated veterinary clinics by searching "[your city] animal shelter clinic" or "[your county] humane society vet services" to find subsidized care options that serve surrounding counties.:** Look for shelter-affiliated veterinary clinics by searching "[your city] animal shelter clinic" or "[your county] humane society vet services" to find subsidized care options that serve surrounding counties.
- ☐ **Find mobile veterinary units and vaccination events by searching "mobile vet [your area]" or checking local pet stores, feed stores, and community centers for low-cost monthly clinics.:** Find mobile veterinary units and vaccination events by searching "mobile vet [your area]" or checking local pet stores, feed stores, and community centers for low-cost monthly clinics.
- ☐ **Call each clinic type to verify they serve your area and ask about income verification requirements, including what documentation like pay stubs or proof of government assistance you need to bring.:** Call each clinic type to verify they serve your area and ask about income verification requirements, including what documentation like pay stubs or proof of government assistance you need to bring.

BUILD YOUR CARE DIRECTORY

- ☐ **Open a new document or grab a piece of paper right now to start building your personalized directory of affordable clinics before an emergency happens.:** Open a new document or grab a piece of paper right now to start building your personalized directory of affordable clinics before an emergency happens.
 - ☐ **Record each clinic's name, address, and phone number in your directory so you have quick access to contact information when your pet needs care.:** Record each clinic's name, address, and phone number in your directory so you have quick access to contact information when your pet needs care.
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- ☐ **Document each clinic's hours of operation and which services they offer, including whether they provide exams, vaccines, surgeries, diagnostics, or emergency care.:** Document each clinic's hours of operation and which services they offer, including whether they provide exams, vaccines, surgeries, diagnostics, or emergency care.
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- ☐ **Call each clinic or check their website to record their price range for common services so you can compare costs and budget for upcoming appointments.:** Call each clinic or check their website to record their price range for common services so you can compare costs and budget for upcoming appointments.

MATCH NEEDS TO CLINIC TYPE

- ☐ **Use nonprofit clinics for routine care, sick visits, chronic condition management, and planned procedures like dentals or mass removals since they offer full-service care at reduced rates.:** Use nonprofit clinics for routine care, sick visits, chronic condition management, and planned procedures like dentals or mass removals since they offer full-service care at reduced rates.
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- ☐ **Visit shelter-affiliated clinics for vaccinations, basic wellness exams, ear infections, skin issues, and minor wounds when you need affordable basic care without specialist equipment.:** Visit shelter-affiliated clinics for vaccinations, basic wellness exams, ear infections, skin issues, and minor wounds when you need affordable basic care without specialist equipment.
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- ☐ **Attend mobile or vaccine clinics to keep vaccines current and refill heartworm or flea prevention medications at the lowest possible cost with no appointment needed.:** Attend mobile or vaccine clinics to keep vaccines current and refill heartworm or flea prevention medications at the lowest possible cost with no appointment needed.
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- ☐ **Reserve regular emergency vet visits for true emergencies only, and save your directory of affordable options for non-critical issues to avoid the highest-cost emergency fees.:** Reserve regular emergency vet visits for true emergencies only, and save your directory of affordable options for non-critical issues to avoid the highest-cost emergency fees.
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